

TEIGHLOR PENGELLEY HEALTH & FITNESS COACHING

6 Principles Every Busy Woman 35+ Needs To Know For Sustainable Fat Loss

Simple strategies to help professional women lose body fat, build lean muscle and boost energy —
without restrictive diets or spending hours in the gym.

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Welcome

If you have picked up this guide, chances are you have tried. More than once. You have tracked meals, cut carbs, joined gyms, followed programmes that promised everything — and still found yourself back at square one, frustrated, exhausted and wondering what you are missing.

You are not missing willpower. You are not failing. You are following advice that was never designed for you.

Most mainstream fitness content is built around a 25-year-old with unlimited time, a simple schedule and a metabolism that responds quickly. That is not your life. You are managing a career, possibly a family, real responsibilities and a body that has changed significantly since your twenties. The rules have shifted, and no one told you.

Here is what I know for certain: sustainable fat loss, increased energy and a stronger body are absolutely possible for women over 35. Not through restriction and extremes — through strategy, consistency and building a lifestyle that actually fits around you.

That is exactly what this guide is about.

Inside, you will find six practical principles that I work through with the women I coach. These are not trendy tips or generic advice. They are the foundations that create lasting change — the kind that does not evaporate the moment life gets busy.

You do not need to overhaul your entire life this week. Read through each principle. Take the reflection prompts seriously. Start with one or two things that resonate and build from there. Small, consistent actions taken over time create results that last.

I created this guide because I genuinely believe that every woman deserves to feel strong, confident and energised in her body — and that it should not require an extreme sacrifice to get there.

You are worth the effort. And this time, you have the right tools.

With warmth,

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Prioritise Protein

Protein is the single most powerful nutritional tool available to women over 35. Full stop.

After 35, your body becomes less efficient at building and maintaining lean muscle. This process, known as age-related muscle loss, accelerates if you are not actively working against it — and protein is the foundation that helps you do exactly that.

Why It Matters

Protein supports muscle maintenance and growth, which directly influences your metabolism and how your body uses energy. It is also the most satiating macronutrient, meaning it keeps you fuller for longer and reduces the urge to snack or overeat. Beyond that, adequate protein supports recovery, energy, hormonal balance and skin health — all things that become increasingly important as you move through your thirties and forties.

Practical Examples

Getting enough protein does not mean eating chicken and rice six times a day. Think eggs at breakfast, Greek yoghurt as a snack, a quality protein source at lunch and dinner, and simple additions like edamame, cottage cheese or legumes throughout the day.

Aim to include a source of protein at every single meal. That one habit alone can meaningfully change how you feel and how your body responds.

The Common Mistake

Most women significantly underestimate how much protein they are actually eating. They eat well, but their diet is largely carbohydrate and fat-heavy, with protein almost an afterthought. Tracking your intake for even a few days can be eye-opening — not to obsess over numbers, but to build awareness.

COACH'S TIP

Start your day with a protein-rich breakfast. Women who do this consistently report better energy, fewer afternoon cravings and greater satisfaction throughout the day. Scrambled eggs, a protein smoothie or full-fat Greek yoghurt with seeds are all excellent starting points.

REFLECTION EXERCISE

Think about your meals over the last three days. Did every meal include a quality protein source? Where were the gaps?

Which one meal could you upgrade with more protein this week?

PRINCIPLE TWO

Lift Weights

If there is one change that will make the most visible, long-lasting difference to your body after 35 — it is strength training.

Cardio has its place. Movement of any kind is valuable. But resistance training is what reshapes your body, maintains lean muscle, supports your metabolism and builds the physical confidence that comes from feeling genuinely strong.

Why Strength Training Matters After 35

As you age, muscle mass naturally declines if it is not actively maintained. Muscle is metabolically active tissue — it burns more energy at rest than fat does. Losing muscle makes fat loss harder. Lifting weights reverses that.

Strength training also supports bone density, which becomes increasingly important for women approaching perimenopause and beyond. It improves posture, reduces injury risk, supports hormonal balance and directly contributes to how you carry yourself with confidence in daily life.

It does not make you bulky. It makes you lean, strong and capable.

How Busy Women Make It Work

You do not need two-hour sessions in the gym. Three focused, well-structured training sessions per week — each lasting 40 to 55 minutes — is enough to create meaningful results when combined with good nutrition and recovery. The key is consistency over time, not daily extremes.

Short on time? Two sessions per week is still significantly better than none. Progress is built through showing up regularly, not perfectly.

COACH'S TIP

Stop waiting until you feel ready or until you have "the right programme." The best strength training programme is one you will actually do. Start where you are. Build the habit first, then refine.

ACTION STEP

Look at your diary for this coming week and block out two or three sessions, each 40 to 55 minutes. Treat them like client meetings — non-negotiable. That is how the habit begins.

PRINCIPLE THREE

Stop Starting Over

One bad meal does not undo a week of progress. One missed training session does not mean you have failed. Yet for so many women, that is exactly what it feels like — and so they start over. Again. And again.

This is one of the most damaging patterns in women's health and fitness. Not because people lack discipline, but because they have been taught an all-or-nothing approach that simply does not work in real life.

"Progress is not destroyed by imperfection. It is destroyed by quitting."

The Problem With Perfectionism

Perfectionism keeps you in a cycle. You do well for a few weeks, something disrupts the routine — work pressure, illness, a holiday — and suddenly you feel like you have lost everything. So you wait for the "right time" to start again. The right time never comes.

Sustainable results are built by women who keep going imperfectly, not by women who are relentlessly consistent until they are not, then start from scratch.

Consistency Is the Goal

Consistency is not about doing everything perfectly every day. It is about doing enough, most of the time, over a long period. A 70 to 80% approach maintained for months will always outperform a 100% approach that collapses after three weeks.

When life disrupts the plan — and it will — the goal is to minimise the disruption and return quickly, not to catastrophise and restart.

Identity Shapes Behaviour

One of the most powerful shifts I see in the women I coach is when they move from "I am trying to eat well" to "I am someone who takes care of

herself." The behaviour follows the identity. When you see yourself as a healthy woman living a healthy life, one off-plan evening becomes a blip, not a failure.

COACH'S INSIGHT

The next time you feel you have "fallen off track," ask yourself: what would a healthy woman who loves herself do right now? She would eat a good meal, get to bed at a decent hour and train tomorrow. She would not punish herself or restart on Monday.

REFLECTION EXERCISE

Think of a time you broke a healthy habit and then stopped entirely. What triggered the break, and what stopped you returning sooner?

What would "continuing imperfectly" have looked like in that moment?

PRINCIPLE FOUR

Plan Like A CEO

You would never let a business-critical meeting be missed because something else came up. Yet that is exactly what happens to health and fitness for most busy women. It stays on the "I'll get to it" list indefinitely.

The women who achieve consistent results treat their health with the same intentionality they bring to their professional lives. They schedule it. They prepare for it. They protect it.

Schedule Your Health Like a Business Priority

Training sessions, meal prep time and rest days are not luxuries. They are non-negotiable appointments. Block them in your diary at the start of each week. If they are in the diary, they happen. If they are not, they do not.

Boundaries and Preparation

Most nutrition falls apart not because of poor choices but because of poor preparation. When there is nothing in the fridge and you are exhausted at 7pm, willpower is not the solution. A stocked kitchen and a simple weekly plan is.

Identify a weekly prep day — even one to two hours on a Sunday evening can make the entire week smoother. Batch cook a protein source, prepare some vegetables, have your go-to meals planned. Remove the decision fatigue that leads to off-plan choices.

Time Is Not the Problem

Most women are not short on time — they are short on *planning*. A 45-minute training session fits inside a lunch break. A protein-based breakfast takes five minutes. The question is not whether you have time. It is whether it is planned.

MY WEEKLY HEALTH PLAN

MY TRAINING DAYS THIS WEEK

MY WEEKLY PREP DAY / TIME

MY GO-TO MEALS (3-5 RELIABLE OPTIONS)

MY BIGGEST OBSTACLE TO CONSISTENCY RIGHT NOW

Prioritise Recovery

You do not get results from training. You get results from recovering from training. That distinction matters more than most women realise.

For women over 35, recovery is not a bonus — it is part of the programme. Sleep, stress management and rest directly influence your hormones, your energy levels, your body composition and your ability to stay consistent over time.

Sleep and Hormonal Health

Poor sleep disrupts the hormones that regulate hunger and fullness, making it significantly harder to make good nutritional choices. It elevates cortisol — the primary stress hormone — which, when chronically high, contributes to fat storage particularly around the midsection. Consistently poor sleep also impairs muscle recovery and reduces training performance.

Seven to nine hours of quality sleep is not an indulgence. It is a physiological necessity for fat loss and long-term health.

Stress and Body Composition

Chronic stress is one of the most overlooked barriers to body composition change in professional women. When your nervous system is consistently in a high-alert state, your body prioritises survival over fat loss. Managing stress is not a lifestyle choice on the side — it is a direct tool for physical results.

Active Recovery

Recovery does not mean doing nothing. Walking, gentle movement, stretching, quality sleep and genuinely enjoyable leisure all support your body's ability to adapt, change and stay healthy over time.

COACH'S TIP

If your energy is consistently low, look at your sleep before you change your training or nutrition. More often than not, the missing piece is recovery — not effort.

- ☐ Aim for seven to nine hours of sleep on the majority of nights

- ☐ Include at least one genuine rest day in your weekly training plan

- ☐ Identify one stress-reducing activity and schedule it as non-negotiable

- ☐ Limit screen time in the hour before bed to support sleep quality

- ☐ Stay well hydrated throughout the day — dehydration increases perceived fatigue

PRINCIPLE SIX

Build Habits You Can Sustain

The best programme you will ever follow is one you can still be doing in twelve months' time. Not the most aggressive, not the most restrictive — the most sustainable.

This is the principle that ties everything together. Every meal, every training session, every recovery habit — it all compounds over time. The women who transform their bodies and their health are not the ones who trained the hardest for eight weeks. They are the ones who did enough, consistently, for a year and beyond.

Think in Seasons, Not Sprints

The fitness industry profits from urgency. "Lose 10 pounds in 30 days." "Your summer body starts now." These messages create the illusion that results are a destination you sprint to and then stop at.

Real results are built slowly, like compound interest. Each small positive action adds to the last. A year from now, you will wish you had started with patience rather than extremes.

Identity and Lifestyle

Sustainable habits are not things you do reluctantly. They are expressions of who you are. When healthy eating, regular movement and genuine self-care become part of your identity rather than a set of rules you are trying to obey, everything becomes easier.

You stop negotiating with yourself. You stop needing motivation every morning. It becomes simply what you do — because it is who you are.

What Sustainable Success Actually Looks Like

It looks like training three times a week, not seven. It looks like eating well 80% of the time and enjoying your social life without guilt. It looks like checking in with yourself, adjusting when needed and continuing rather than starting over. It looks like feeling genuinely well in your body, most days, for the long term.

JOURNAL PROMPT ONE

What does your healthiest, most confident self look like — not in terms of a dress size, but in terms of how she feels, moves and operates day to day?

JOURNAL PROMPT TWO

What is one health or fitness habit you have repeatedly tried and abandoned? What would it look like to do a smaller, more sustainable version of that habit this month?

THE NEXT STEP

Ready To Become Stronger, Leaner & More Confident?

The StrongHER Accelerator is an 8-week coaching experience designed specifically for busy women 35+ who want lasting results.

This is not another generic programme. It is a structured, personally supported experience built around your life, your schedule and the principles you have just worked through — brought to life with consistent accountability and expert guidance.

WHAT YOU'LL GAIN

- ☐ Noticeably more energy in your daily life
- ☐ Better, more reliable daily routines
- ☐ Increased strength and physical capability
- ☐ Improved confidence in your body and how you carry yourself
- ☐ Sustainable habits that outlast the programme
- ☐ Reduced body fat through consistent, manageable strategies
- ☐ Greater consistency than you have experienced before

WHAT'S INCLUDED

- Monthly one-to-one coaching calls
- Private coaching community for ongoing support
- Personalised accountability check-ins
- Habit tracking and progress review
- Health and nutrition education resources
- Training guidance tailored to your schedule
- Curated resources, guides and tools throughout
- Sustainable strategies that continue working long after the programme ends

What Women Often Discover

Every woman's journey is her own. But there are patterns I see repeatedly — shifts in how women feel and what becomes possible when the right foundations are in place.

"Women often tell me that the biggest change they notice first is their energy. Not a dramatic transformation overnight, but a gradual, steady improvement in how they feel waking up and how they manage the afternoon slump. Many say it feels like they have got their life back."

"Clients commonly experience a shift in their relationship with consistency. They come in having tried and stopped many times. Over the course of the programme, they begin to recognise the all-or-nothing pattern they had been stuck in — and they start building a different one. One that does not collapse under pressure."

"Many women discover that confidence was the real goal all along. They came for fat loss. They stayed for how they began to feel about themselves. Stronger in the gym, more decisive at work, more present at home. That is the result that matters most."

YOUR NEXT STEP

Your Next Step Starts Here

You don't need another diet. You don't need more willpower.

You need a system. You need support. You need accountability.

If you are ready to feel stronger, leaner and more confident — and you want to do it in a way that actually fits your life — let's talk. Book your free introductory call and let's find out how we can make this work for you.

BOOK YOUR INTRODUCTORY CALL

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